A Classical Economics Presentation Title

Optional Subtitle or Paper Version

Your Name

Department of Economics
Your University

Seminar / Course / Conference
September 2026

Roadmap

1. Motivation
2. Background and Framework
3. Data and Research Design
4. Results
5. Mechanisms and Robustness
6. Conclusion

Motivation

- Start with the economic question, not the method.
- Give one or two facts that make the question important.
- Explain the gap in the existing literature.
- End with what your paper contributes.

Main question

How does X affect Y, and through which economic mechanism?

What This Paper Does

1. Introduces a new setting / dataset / source of variation.
2. Estimates the main relationship of interest.
3. Studies mechanisms or heterogeneous effects.
4. Connects the results to a broader economic question.

Main takeaway: State the result in one sentence with an economically meaningful magnitude.

Institutional Background

- What is the institution, policy, market, or environment?
- What should the audience know before seeing the empirical design?
- Which dates, rules, or thresholds matter?

Keep this slide selective

Only include institutional details that are needed to understand the economic mechanism or research design.

A Simple Economic Framework

A generic relationship can be written as

$$y_i = f(x_i, z_i; \theta) + \varepsilon_i, \qquad i = 1, \ldots, n.$$

- y_i: outcome of interest.
- x_i: key explanatory variable.
- z_i: other observed characteristics.
- θ: parameter(s) with economic interpretation.

Presentation tip: do not put every equation from the paper on slides. Show only equations needed for the argument.

Useful Equation Layout

$$U(c_1, c_2) = u(c_1) + \beta u(c_2), \tag{1}$$

$$c_1 + \frac{c_2}{1+r} = w. \tag{2}$$

- Put alignment marker `&` before the equality sign.
- Use `\\` to start the next aligned line.
- Use `\quad` for a clean horizontal separation inside math.

Data

- **Source:** Administrative / survey / transaction / historical data.
- **Unit of observation:** Individual, firm, county, country, etc.
- **Period:** 2000–2025.
- **Main outcome:** Define it in plain English first.
- **Sample:** Explain key restrictions.

Good data slide rule

The audience should know what one row of your dataset represents before you show a regression table.

Summary Statistics

Variable	Mean	Std. Dev.	N
Outcome Y	12.40	4.10	12 500
Treatment X	0.36	0.48	12 500
Income	58.20	21.70	12 500
Age	41.30	12.60	12 500

Notes: Replace this with a concise description of the sample and units.

Research Design

Core idea

Explain the source of identifying variation in words before showing the estimating equation.

A generic specification is

$$Y_{it} = \alpha + \beta X_{it} + \gamma' Z_{it} + \mu_i + \tau_t + \varepsilon_{it}.$$

- β is the parameter of interest.
- μ_i denotes unit fixed effects.
- τ_t denotes time fixed effects.

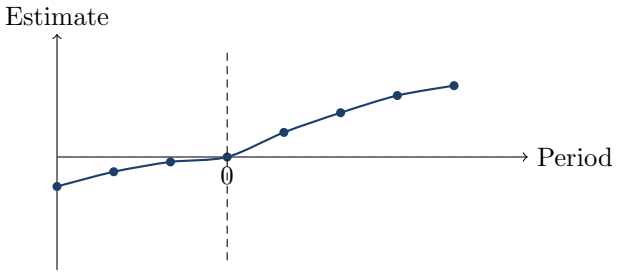
Main Result

	(1)	(2)	(3)
X	0.118***	0.104***	0.072**
	(0.031)	(0.034)	(0.029)
Controls	No	Yes	Yes
Unit FE	No	No	Yes
Time FE	No	Yes	Yes
Observations	12,500	12,500	12,500
R^2	0.11	0.24	0.39

Notes: Standard errors in parentheses. *, **, and *** denote significance at the 10%, 5%, and 1% levels.

Interpretation: translate the preferred coefficient into an economically meaningful magnitude.

Main Figure



Notes: Keep figure notes short on slides. Explain the key pattern orally and use a clear title that states the result.

How to Present a Result

1. State the sign and direction.
2. Give the magnitude.
3. Translate the magnitude into economically meaningful units.
4. Say what comparison or variation identifies it.
5. Then discuss statistical precision.

Avoid

Reading every coefficient and standard error from the table.

Mechanism

Mechanism 1

Economic channel and corresponding empirical prediction.

Mechanism 2

Alternative channel and how the data distinguish it.

Goal: connect the mechanism tests to the conceptual framework, rather than presenting disconnected regressions.

Robustness

- Alternative sample definitions.
- Alternative outcome or treatment definitions.
- Alternative controls / fixed effects.
- Placebo or falsification tests.
- Alternative inference / clustering choices.

Presentation tip

Do not show ten robustness tables in the main talk. Summarize the pattern and move detailed tables to the appendix.

Conclusion

1. **Question:** one-line reminder of the research question.
2. **Finding:** main empirical or theoretical result.
3. **Mechanism:** what explains the result.
4. **Implication:** why the finding matters for economics.

Thank you

Appendix: Additional Result

- Put detailed robustness checks here.
- Put derivations, alternative specifications, extra figures, and data details here.
- During Q&A, jump directly to the relevant backup slide.

Appendix: Example Derivation

Suppose

$$\max_{c_1, c_2} \; u(c_1) + \beta u(c_2)$$

subject to

$$c_1 + \frac{c_2}{1+r} = w.$$

The first-order condition is

$$u'(c_1) = \beta(1+r)u'(c_2).$$

References


Author, A. (2024). “Paper Title.” *Journal Name*, 100(2), 1–25.


Author, B. and C. Author (2022). “Another Paper.” *Working Paper*.